



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 01/09/2026	Entry: 1
Description	Phishing ransomware attack.
Tool(s) used	Encryption malware and email services.
The 5 W's	The attack was caused by an organised group of unethical hackers. They sent an email to spear phish employees of the company into downloading ransomware that encrypted database information and demanded money in return for the key so the data could be decrypted. It was done in the USA on a Tuesday morning at 9AM with a financial incentive.
Additional notes	Staff members likely received ineffective training on phishing attacks, as a link must have been interacted with for the ransomware to have been downloaded.

Date: 04/09/2026	Entry: 2
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Description	Hash phishing attack
Tool(s) used	Use of a known malicious file hash within an email
The 5 W's	The name given in the email is Clyde West. An email was sent to the HR department claiming to be interested in a role with an attached document that was supposedly their resume but was instead a known malicious hash that downloads a trojan fragtor. The incident occurred on the 20th July, 2022. Due to the nature of the malware, it was likely deployed in an attempt to use it as ransomware through database encryption.

Date: 04/09/2026	Entry: 3
Description	Unauthorised access to PII achieved
Tool(s) used	E-commerce web app vulnerability to SQL injections
The 5 W's	An external threat actor performed a SQL attack on the e-commerce web app to gain access to customer information. Occurred on December 28, 2022, at 7:20 p.m. The customer data was used as ransom with an initial fee of 25000 dollars increasing to 50000 after non-compliance.